

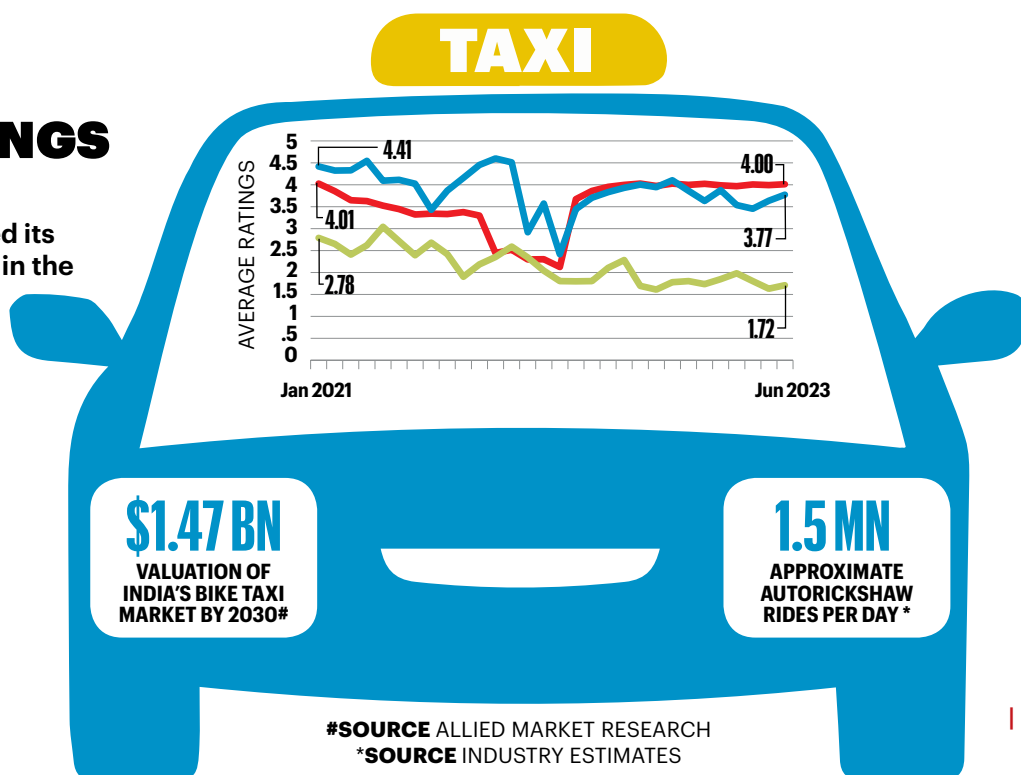
THE RATINGS GAME

Uber has maintained its lead in user ratings in the past one year

— UBER
— OLA
— BLUSMART MOBILITY

NOTE DATA INCLUDES APP RANKINGS AND REVIEWS FOR THE CUSTOMER APP AS WELL AS THE DRIVER APP; PLAY STORE REVIEWS ARE NOT SPLIT BY GEOGRAPHY; HENCE IT IS WORLDWIDE AND NOT INDIA. ALL OTHER DATA FOR INDIA ONLY

SOURCE SYNAPTIC



cision that is proving costly for its mobility dreams.

Several people that *BT* spoke to say the layoffs and top-level exodus at Ola over the past few years have significantly weakened its mobility team. “The continuous churn at Ola went on and there is no strong leadership to really run the mobility business. There has not been a dedicated senior-level person looking at mobility for some time. It is running on auto pilot,” says a person who has worked with the company.

In an effort to make the cost structure of the electric division appear more reasonable, Aggarwal is allocating some of the mobility resources, states a former employee.

“When electric started doing

well, it was a clear decision from Aggarwal to go slow on mobility. He owns about 40 per cent in the EV business, and just about 8-9 per cent in mobility. In his mind, it is very clear that every second devoted to EV is more beneficial than time devoted to mobility,” says a person closely aware of Ola’s operations. Ola did not respond to a detailed questionnaire sent to it till the time of going to press.

Ola Electric was valued at \$6 billion in its last funding round in May. Per market intelligence platform PrivateCircle Research, Ola’s ride-hailing business unit—ANI Technologies Private Ltd—was valued at \$6.5 billion as of May 2022. But investment bankers say its mobility

business might struggle to get even half that valuation now. That’s perhaps why the firm isn’t rushing to complete its planned IPO.

As the market opens up, it presents Uber an opportunity to raise its share further. The key lies in its commitment to investing in innovation and strategic collaborations. “After being so big for a long time, if you lose so much market share, it is extremely expensive and near impossible to gain back. Ola doesn’t have the money; nobody is funding mobility. So it is very unlikely that they will be able to regain market share. It is now up to Uber as to how much they want to push. If they want to spend money and gain market share, [this] is the right time and [it] would be fairly